situation prevails in Indian-administered Kashmir, which is known in India as the state of Jammu and Kashmir. Technically this state has more autonomy than others in the Indian Union and its special status is enshrined in the Indian constitution. However, for most of its history, New Delhi has ruled Indian-administered Kashmir using a ‘combination of direct control and intrusive intervention.’ This included sponsoring local governments that were unrepresentative of and unaccountable to the populace.[9] The aim has been to marginalize independent leaders in favor of the pro-accession National Conference party, and as in Pakistan-administered Kashmir, those wishing to stand for election must swear allegiance to the Indian constitution, in effect acknowledging Indian sovereignty.[10] Pakistan has ingrained in its citizenry the importance of recovering the remaining two-thirds of Kashmir, just as India has promoted the idea among its populace that ceding any of this territory would threaten the entire nation’s fabric. Many Kashmiris simply want independence, or at least greater autonomy.

War erupted again in 1965 when Pakistan launched Operations Gibraltar and Grand Slam. Pakistan had been attempting to sow the seeds of rebellion in Indian-administered Kashmir through covert various activities. Perhaps sensing Indian vulnerability following its defeat to China in the 1962 Sino-Indian War, it increased these activities while also planning a larger invasion. In August 1965 Pakistan launched Operation Gibraltar, so named for the invasion of Spain in 711 CE from the rugged Mediterranean promontory. Companies were formed consisting of irregulars, particularly from Pakistan-administered Kashmir, into which soldiers from paramilitary units were integrated. Army officers at the major rank commanded units consisting of four to six companies, which infiltrated across the LoC. Approximately 30,000 men were involved in the infiltration, which was intended to prepare the ground for a subsequent intervention by the Pakistan army. The plan was predicated on the belief that local forces would rise up and join a rebellion against Indian rule, but little local help was forthcoming. Rather than retreat, Pakistan launched Operation Grand Slam, which entailed deploying conventional troops. The army had early success, but an Indian counter-invasion soon threatened sovereign Pakistani territory, and by the end of September the two had signed a ceasefire. In early 1966 the two sides agreed to the positions they held prior to the August 1965 invasion.[11]